airtel

SYNC

Airtel Udyam

A small business goes digital in one sitting

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Unique · Mayank Kataria

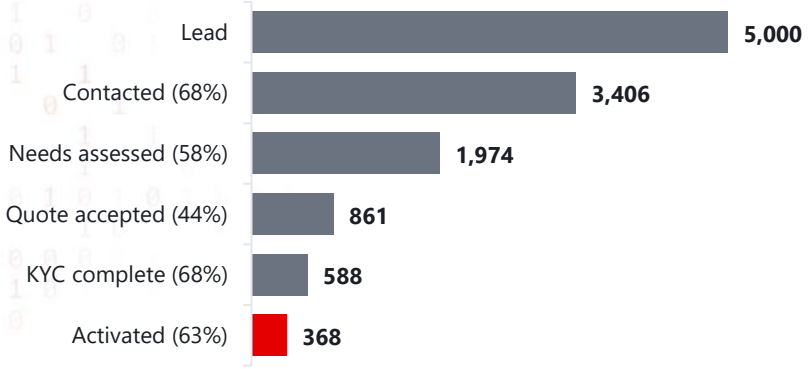
Live prototype https://airtel-udyam-kappa.vercel.app
Code github.com/Unique0202/Team_Shenron_Airtel_Hackathon



Platform Partner unstop

Only 7 in 100 interested businesses become customers

One quarter of SMB leads (5,000, Apr–Jun 2026): 17.6 days to activate, 3 status calls per customer, ₹15,053 to acquire each customer



Funnel stage (% of previous stage). Source: smb_leads.csv

What we found in the data

Status chasing predicts churn: 1 call 6% churn, 5 calls 28%.
Digital leads are cheapest (₹112–274 per lead) but 26–32% are never reached.
Sales sells the target, not the need: 5G AirFiber asked 39×, sold 9×.
No GSTIN, no deal: 2.0% conversion vs 9.6%; Tamil leads via field sales 2.6%.

Where the 4,632 lost leads went, and what fixes it

Why they left	Leads	Our fix
Never reached, or no one visited	1,951	Advisor works any time, no visit
Quote slow, complex or too pricey	1,006	Instant plain bill, right-sized bundle
Not interested, locked in, mobile only	1,182	Better targeting; start with one SIM
Paperwork, mismatched documents	273	Smart KYC + e-sign
Waited after KYC (install, payment)	220	Tracker; check feasibility upfront

2,830 of the lost leads (61%) dropped for reasons a self-serve journey removes: no visit, slow or confusing quote, paperwork, silence after KYC.

Who to win first, with what bundle, at what price

Lead with professional offices, win micro businesses digitally, keep field sales for chains. Bundles are the prototype's real output.

1 Professional offices

25% of leads · 11.1% convert · lowest CAC (₹10,695)

Example: Dental clinic, 2 sites, 12 staff

Fibre 300 ×2, cloud backup, endpoint security, managed firewall, cloud email

₹9,811 / month

2-year plan, setup halved to ₹4,000

Digital-first: owners are online and need uptime + data safety

2 Micro retail & services

54% of leads · 4.1% convert · CAC ₹20,007 vs ₹2,470 bill

Example: Kirana in Lucknow, 3 staff, no GSTIN

5G AirFiber (no fibre wait), cloud POS & billing, 2 CCTV cameras, website

₹2,825 / month

No GST paperwork needed; live in 4 days

Digital only: a field visit costs more than 8 months of revenue

3 Multi-site & manufacturers

21% of leads · 11–13% convert · ₹16–28k bills, churn 8–11%

Example: Restaurant chain, 5 outlets, 60 staff

Fibre 300 ×5, SD-WAN, 4G failover, CCTV, cloud telephony, 6 SIMs

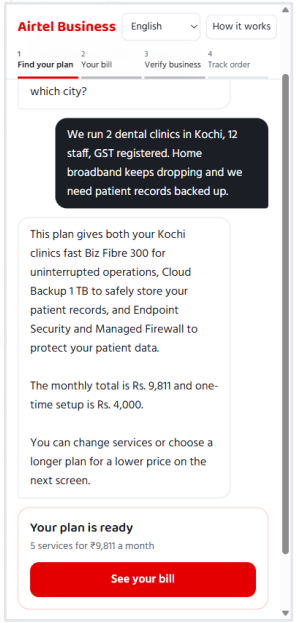
₹33,754 / month

2-year plan (SD-WAN minimum)

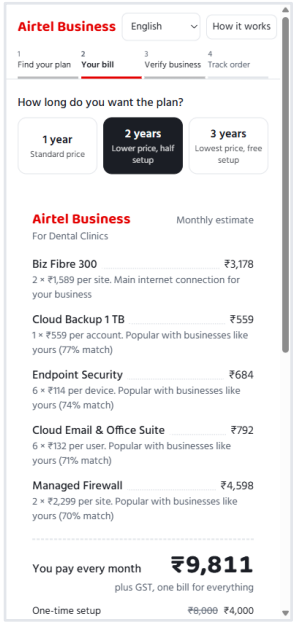
Field sales, with the advisor pre-qualifying the lead

1 Chat — 5 minutes, 10 languages, voice → **2 Bill** — instant, one monthly price → **3 Verify** — 10 minutes, consent first → **4 Track** — install in 2–7 days, no calls

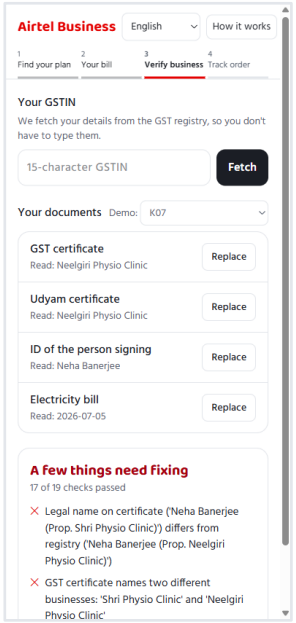
Working prototype: first message to placed order, on a phone



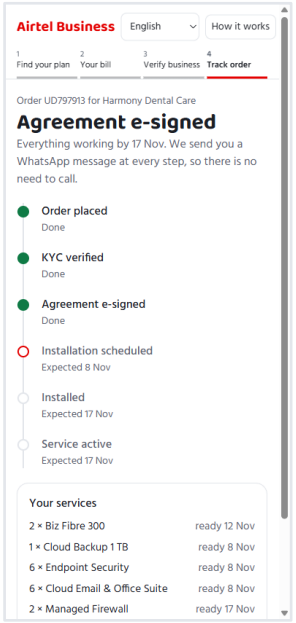
1 Advisor understands the business and explains the plan in plain words



2 One monthly bill like a shop receipt; toggle services, pick 1–3 years



3 Smart KYC caught a planted problem: two business names on one GST certificate



4 Order tracker with expected dates replaces status calls

Try it

airtel-udyam-kappa.vercel.app

Tested

Hindi + English chats end to end; 10 languages and voice input

Rules catch all 6 planted KYC problems in the 12 sample applicants; the 6 clean ones pass

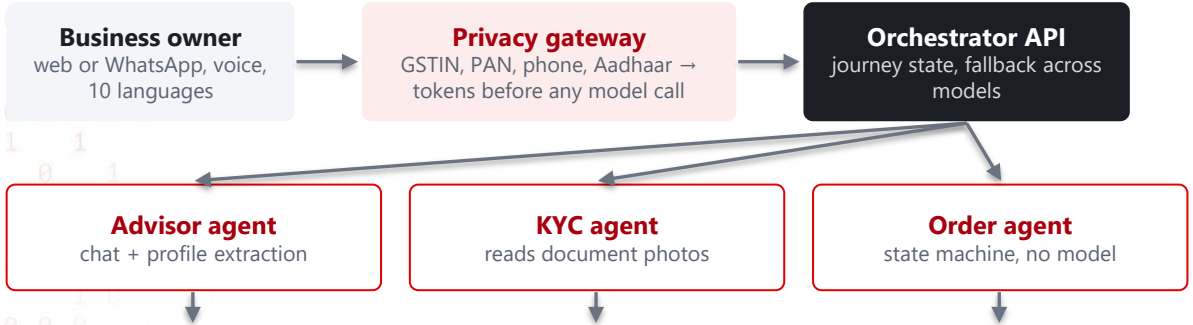
Every recommended bundle passes eligibility, dependency and budget rules (automated tests)

Also built

Under-the-hood panel: profile, ML scores, what the model saw

Partner console: dropped leads ranked by likelihood to convert

Agents talk, rules decide: built for regulated customer data



Why judges can trust the output: the language model only converses and extracts. Which products are allowed, what they cost and whether KYC passes is decided by code, so the advisor cannot invent a price or sell an ineligible product. Busy or out-of-quota models fail over in seconds; each document photo is read only once.

Privacy by design (DPDP Act 2023)

Consent first: purpose, what is collected, retention and withdrawal shown before KYC

Tokenization at source: identifiers never reach the external model

Masking in screens, API responses and logs (32TTNX•••••T1ZW)

Minimisation: registry lookup pre-fills details; only 4 documents asked

Retention: photos are read in memory, never stored; only the verification result is kept

Localisation: production runs the model in an India region or on Airtel's Agent Bridge

Telecom rules: business KYC is instant; each SIM user still completes their own e-KYC

Rivals stop at “request a callback”; we close online, on one bill

	Bundle across products	Online checkout	Indian languages	One bill	Digital KYC	Entry price / month
Jio Business	Partly: BB + cloud + landline	Partly: buy online or callback	No (English pages)	Partly	No, at install	₹801 (100 Mbps)
Vi Business	No: mobile only	Partly: form, 48 h callback	Not stated	No	Partly, doorstep	Not published
Tata Tele Business	Partly: office packs	No: callback, partners	Partly: voice AI	Partly	No	Quote only
Airtel Business today	No: separate silos	No: callback in 1 day	No	No	No	₹499 (2022 list)
Local ISPs	No: broadband only	Partly: app booking	Local staff	No	Partly, app upload	~₹699
Single-product apps	No: one tool each	Yes, minutes	Partly	No	Yes	₹59–2,799 each
Airtel Udyam (ours)	**Yes: 25 products, rules-checked**	**Yes**	**Yes: 10 + voice**	**Yes**	**Yes: registry + e-sign**	**₹2,825 (kirana bundle)**

Where we win

- Close simple cases online; telcos all stop at a callback
- One bundle, one bill replaces 4–6 vendors (ISP, telco, WhatsApp, email, POS, CCTV)
- Only Airtel owns network, SIMs, WhatsApp channel and partners to do it

Watch out

- Jio sets the price anchor (₹801): sell total value, not Mbps
- Tata Tele is moving to advisor + voice AI; speed matters
- SaaS apps sign up in minutes: our checkout must match

Field force & partners

- Advisor closes simple cases; complex and dropped leads go to people
- Partner console ranks leads: top 20% hold 47% of activations
- Partners earn commission on assisted digital sign-ups; installs stay human

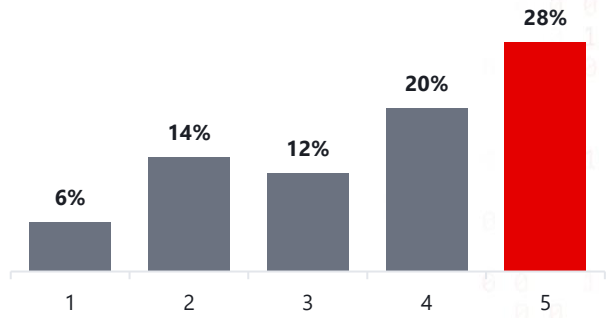
Sources: operator websites and press, Oct 2025 – Nov 2026 (full list in analysis/competition.md).

Impact: 2× the customers from the same leads, at 60% lower cost

Metric	Today	Target (12 mo)	Lever
Lead → activation	7.4%	15%	No-visit and quote drops recovered online
Time to activate	17.6 days	≤ 7 days	Instant quote and KYC; install is the only wait
Acquisition cost	₹15,053	≤ ₹6,000	Micro and digital leads off field sales
Status calls / customer	3.0	< 0.5	Tracker + proactive WhatsApp updates
6-month churn	15.2%	≤ 10%	Fewer chases, right-sized bundles (≤ 6 items)

Same 5,000 leads a quarter: 368 → 750 customers. At the median ₹6,900 bill that is about ₹3.2 crore more annual revenue from each quarter's leads, for ₹45 lakh of acquisition spend instead of ₹55 lakh today.

6-month churn by status calls the customer made



Status calls per activated customer (n = 368)

Rollout

0–3 months: pilot in Kochi and Lucknow, professional offices + micro, 3 languages

3–9 months: 10 cities, WhatsApp front end, partner console to channel partners

9–12 months: national, 10 languages, on Airtel's Agent Bridge

Risks and mitigations

Wrong advice: rules decide, human handoff in one tap

Model outage or quota: multi-model fallback, cached reads

Channel conflict: partners paid on assisted digital deals

SIM KYC rules: per-user e-KYC built into the tracker

Next

Site-feasibility check before the quote (41 leads lost to “fibre not feasible”)

GST registration help for the 29% of leads without a GSTIN

A/B test the advisor against field sales in the pilot